



COVAXIN BLOW

KRISHNA ELLA has been delivered a downer. The World Health Organization (WHO) has suspended the supply of Covaxin—the Covid-19 vaccine manufactured by Bharat Biotech—through UN procurement agencies, due to deficiencies in good manufacturing practices (GMP). WHO clarified that Covaxin is effective and no safety concerns exist. Covaxin's export has been suspended for now.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA



IPL's Badshah

BCCI Secretary Jay Shah has kicked off an expensive bidding war by setting the total base price for cricket's IPL rights for 2023-27 at a whopping ₹32,890 crore. And as Zee, Sony Pictures Networks, Network18, Disney Star, Amazon and a host of smaller digital players battle it out for different rights in the e-auction slated for June, BCCI looks set to be the real winner of the tournament.

—VIDYA S.

SSANGYONG UNSOLD

LOOKS LIKE IT WILL take a while for **Anand Mahindra** to get debt-ridden SsangYong Motor off his back. The deal to sell the SUV specialist to South Korean electric carmaker Edison Motors has been called off. M&M says that it was because Edison was unable to deposit the

bid amount as per the terms of the investment agreement—SsangYong was acquired by a consortium led by Edison for \$254.56 million. M&M has a controlling 75 per cent stake in SsangYong and has been looking for a buyer for long.

—PRERNA LIDHOO



Of Privacy and Trust

Given the multitude of unseemly characters and trolls on social media, there has been rising demand for making verification of social media accounts mandatory. But the government does not intend to do any such thing, Minister of State for Electronics and IT **Rajeev Chandrasekhar** told the Lok Sabha recently. He said the government's focus is on balancing matters of privacy as well as the interests of safety and trust. The stand assumes significance as internet platforms such as Google and Facebook-owned WhatsApp have challenged India's new IT rules, arguing they violate the right to privacy.

—BINU PAUL

While there has been rising demand to verify social media accounts, the government does not intend to do so as its focus is on matters of privacy, safety and trust, Minister of State for Electronics and IT Rajeev Chandrasekhar has said

Our Man at FedEx

RAJ SUBRAMANIAM, 54, is the latest entrant to the ever-expanding club of Indian Americans helming leading US companies. Subramaniam will take over from FedEx Founder Fredrick W. Smith as the \$84-billion company's President & CEO this June. Known to be highly spiritual and a cricket buff, Subramaniam will have his hands full captaining the Memphis-headquartered company at a time of intense disruption.

—MANISH PANT



SHAKTIMAN MOVES

In the first monetary policy of FY23, RBI Governor **Shaktikanta Das** said he now prioritises inflation over growth, and gave a hawkish commentary on the state of the economy, yet decided to keep the repo and reverse repo rate unchanged. But he did introduce a Standing Deposit Facility or SDF at 3.75 per cent.

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL